

Acceptable Use Policy (AUP)

2.1 Purpose

This policy defines and sets rules that defines acceptable and unacceptable use of organizational digital resources including information systems, networks, and data to protect the organization, its members, and employees. It outlines permissible and prohibited actions and the consequences of any violations. This sets clear expectations for all stakeholders.

2.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

- All users of organizational systems including employees, vendors, contractors, temporary staff and other workers
- All devices accessing organizational resources
- All information assets owned or leased by the organization, regardless of format or location

2.3 General Use Principles

1. Authorized users should be aware that the data and files created using corporate systems become property of the organization.
2. All users have a responsibility to exercise good judgement regarding personal use of organization resources. Departmental policies need to be put in place to provide guidelines on the use of organization resources for personal use. In the absence of such policies, users should contact their supervisor or management.
3. Organization reserves the right to audit their digital assets on a periodic basis to ensure compliance with set policy.
4. Users must protect the information entrusted to them to ensure the CIA Triad is upheld
5. Users must act responsibly and ethically
6. Users must use systems for legitimate purposes

2.4 Security and Propriety Information

1. Users have an obligation to keep passwords secure and to not share accounts. Authorized users are responsible for the security of their passwords and accounts. User passwords should comply with the password policy.
2. Information in digital assets should be classified based on its sensitivity, value and risk and appropriate security, governance and compliance measures put in place to protect the data from unauthorized access, disclosure or modification.
3. Portable devices essentially vulnerable to theft should be encrypted to ensure data is protected in case the device is lost.
4. All devices used by authorized users to access organization digital assets should contain approved virus-scanning software with a current database.

2.5. Clear Desk and Clear Screen

To mitigate the risk of unauthorized access and potential loss of information, the organization mandates adherence to a Clear Desk and Clear Screen Policy, outlined as follows:

1. Employees are required to protect personal and confidential business information by utilizing available security controls, including secure print options on organizational printers.
2. Computers must be locked with a password protected screen locking mechanism when left unattended.
3. Employees must ensure that confidential materials are not left unattended on printers or photocopiers.
4. All business-related printed documents must be securely disposed off using designated confidential waste bins or approved shredding equipment.

2.6 Unacceptable Use

These activities are generally prohibited. Under no circumstance should anyone affiliated with the organization authorized to engage in any activity prescribed as illegal under local or international law using the organization resources.

2.6.1 Access Control

Access is through a unique user ID and password. Individuals are responsible for activities carried out using their user ID

Individuals should NOT:

1. Transfer data to unauthorized external parties with no authority or affiliation with the organization
2. Store data on non-authorized devices
3. Attempt to access, utilize or modify data without proper authority.
4. Share or use another person's credentials to access systems
5. Leave their user account logged in at an unlocked computer
6. Connect unauthorized devices to company systems

2.6.2 Internet and Email Use

The organization internet and email resources should be used for business purposes. Personal use is permitted when such use does not affect an individual's business performance and is not in breach of any legal, regulatory or business obligations.

Individuals should NOT:

1. Download copyrighted material without appropriate approval
2. Download any software from the internet not in the approved list without prior approval from the IT department. This is applicable even if the software is utilized for an individual's job function.
3. Forward company business to personal email account
4. Send data externally without adhering to the data classification policy. Exposes sensitive, copyrighted and confidential data to increased risk of exposure.
5. Post information on the internet that relates to the organization or express any opinion on behalf of the organization unless authorized to do so.
6. Use organization email to conduct personal business and for personal gain
7. Access, share, receive or download any data considered offensive in any way and would compromise the credibility of the organization including explicit, defamatory, derogatory or discriminatory information.
8. Use inappropriate language including profanity, obscenities and derogatory remarks in official communications
9. Demonstrate vigilance against phishing and email-based scams, ensuring timely escalation to IT teams preventing phishing and fraud.

2.7 Remote Working

The following guidelines should be applied when organization business is conducted away from its premises:

1. All remote working activities should be conducted according to the remote working policy.
2. Company owned equipment and portable assets used off-site should be protected and not left unattended in public areas.
3. All mobile and portable devices used remotely should be secured using strong authentication mechanisms in line with the password policy and encrypted.
4. Employees should use secure and trusted networks and avoid unsecured public internet when working remotely.
5. Devices should be locked when left unattended regardless of the location